

ALI HEJAZIZO

AI Lead Engineer

+780-680-3295

hejazizo.ali@gmail.com

Toronto, Canada

hejazizo

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pytopia.ai

HIGHLIGHTS

- AI Leadership:** Founded and built Vendoroo's AI team from scratch, shipping text (LlamaIndex, LangGraph/LangChain, AutoGen) and voice (VAPI, LiveKit, ElevenLabs) agents that power end-to-end property management workflows for 70,000+ residential units
- LLM Expertise:** Fine-tuned LLMs with LoRA and RLHF (GRPO) for a 38% user engagement lift at Dippy AI, alongside deep experience building production agentic systems
- Technical Architecture:** Designed scalable backends with FastAPI, RabbitMQ, PostgreSQL, Redis, and Celery powering real-time agent workflows
- Entrepreneurial Impact:** Founded Pytopia, building a custom LMS from scratch that today serves 20,000+ students across Python, ML, Agentic AI, and Statistics

WORK EXPERIENCE

Vendoroo
Oct 2024 - Present

Founding AI Lead

Founding AI Engineer at Vendoroo, where I lead a team of AI engineers developing cutting-edge agentic AI solutions that revolutionize communication workflows in the real estate property maintenance sector. Our technology functions as an intelligent assistant that streamlines and automates complex maintenance processes, essentially "Cursor for real estate property maintenance."

What I Do:

- Built the AI team from scratch and architect our agentic AI framework, integrating advanced LLM technologies into practical real estate maintenance solutions
- Shipped text agents with LlamaIndex, LangGraph/LangChain, and AutoGen, plus voice agents on VAPI, LiveKit, and ElevenLabs, powering end-to-end property management workflows for 70,000+ residential units
- Lead technical strategy for our AI team, balancing innovation with practical, scalable solutions
- Drive product development from conception to deployment with high ownership and autonomy

Technical Leadership:

Building a product that transforms how property managers handle maintenance communication through:

- Intelligent workflow automation that reduces manual processing by property managers
- Agentic systems that can autonomously coordinate between tenants, property managers, and service providers

Pytopia
May 2021 - Present

Founder

Founded Pytopia and built the entire platform end-to-end — designing and engineering a custom Learning Management System (LMS) from scratch that today serves more than 20,000 students.

- Designed and built the full LMS from scratch, owning both the frontend and backend, now serving 20,000+ students.
- Developed and delivered computer science courses including Python, Machine Learning, Agentic AI, and Statistics.
- Implemented a mentorship program providing personalized guidance to students to accelerate their learning and career prospects.
- Organized and facilitated both online and in-person events, creating networking opportunities for the community.

Dippy.ai
Aug 2024 - Dec 2024

Senior AI Engineer

AI Engineer specializing in LLMs and conversational AI at Dippy.ai. Improved character-based chat systems through fine-tuning and reinforcement learning techniques.

Key Achievements

- Fine-tuned LLMs using LoRA and Reinforcement Learning from Human Feedback (GRPO), resulting in 38% increase in user engagement
- Conducted comprehensive model evaluations and A/B testing via Amplitude
- Implemented robust content safety systems for detecting NSFW content and protecting underage users

Antler
May 2024 - Aug 2024

Founder in Residence

Selected to join Antler's prestigious Cohort 6 as a Founder in Residence, where I underwent an intensive 4-month startup development program. During this transformative experience:

- Received coaching and mentorship from successful entrepreneurs and industry experts
- Developed and refined business concepts through rigorous validation processes
- Gained deep expertise in market analysis, product-market fit, and go-to-market strategies
- Built a valuable network with fellow founders, investors, and startup ecosystem leaders
- Acquired pitching skills and learned effective fundraising approaches
- Utilized Antler's proven methodology to accelerate from concept to viable business model

This experience equipped me with the entrepreneurial toolkit, strategic mindset, and founder network essential for building scalable, innovative ventures

Affinity.co
2021 - 2024

Senior Machine Learning Engineer

- Led a team of 3 engineers and implemented a two-stage structured information extraction system using Large Language Models (LLMs), improving accuracy from 54% to 88%. The first stage utilized Q&A models, while the second stage leveraged advanced LLMs for enhanced performance.
- Created a connection suggestion feature for investors by identifying individuals with overlapping work experiences, enabling targeted networking with key personnel in desired companies.
- Applied advanced NLP techniques and LLMs to normalize data across job titles, locations, and industry tags, ensuring consistency and accuracy throughout the platform.
- Implemented data deduplication processes using blocking and matching algorithms on company and people records, significantly reducing redundancy and improving data quality.
- Designed and deployed gender and ethnicity detection models based on name and profile picture analysis, providing valuable demographic insights for users.

AltaML
2018 - 2021

Machine Learning Engineer

3+ years in development and deployment of machine learning algorithms.

- Developed and deployed advanced Natural Language Processing (NLP) and Computer Vision models, contributing to project success.
- Developed and deployed customer service chatbots.
- Collaborated closely with cross-functional teams to translate business objectives into technical solutions, ensuring alignment with project goals.

EDUCATION

University of Alberta
Edmonton, Canada
2016 - 2020

M.Sc. of Computer Science

- GPA: 3.9/4
- Thesis:
 - Combining Variational Sampling and Metropolis–Hastings Sampling for Paraphrase Generation
 - Supervisor: Denilson Barbosa

HONORS AND AWARDS

- Ranked 1st in Electrical Engineering, Power Group, among more than 30 students.
- Granted admission from Talented Student Office of Amirkabir University of Technology for graduate study.